从车库到世界之巅

From a Garage to the Top of the World



离开苹果后，乔布斯怎样走回苹果?

READ 纯净阅读

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RECALL 回想巩固

英文原文

In May 1985, after a bruising confrontation, Apple's board ultimately backed chief executive John Sculley. Steve Jobs, 30, was stripped of his managerial duties at the company he had co-founded. That September, sidelined and alienated, he resigned.

Rewind three decades. Born in San Francisco on 24 February 1955, Jobs was adopted as a newborn. On 1 April 1976 he founded Apple with Steve Wozniak, the electronics engineer behind its first prototypes. Apple's garage origins are largely symbolic; Wozniak calls their significance inflated. Apple floated on 12 December 1980; the flagship Macintosh debuted on 24 January 1984.

Exile proved productive. Later in 1985 Jobs founded NeXT, a computer start-up. In February 1986 he acquired Lucasfilm's computer-graphics outfit, which became Pixar. It began as a manufacturer of specialised hardware, not chiefly an animation studio. Toy Story, released on 22 November 1995, was the first feature-length computer-animated film.

The reversal came on 20 December 1996: Apple agreed to buy NeXT, gaining the core software of the eventual Mac OS X and reuniting with its estranged co-founder. In August 1997 Microsoft invested $150 million in its distressed competitor; that September Jobs took the reins as interim chief. Apple, he later said, had been weeks from ruin. The iMac, iPod, and iPhone followed, the iPhone showcased on 9 January 2007.

In October 2003 Jobs received a diagnosis: an uncommon, cancerous pancreatic tumour. In August 2011 Apple briefly overtook Exxon Mobil as the world's most valuable company. His tenure ended on 24 August 2011; he died on 5 October 2011, aged 56. He had spent nearly fourteen years at the helm of the company that ousted him.

中文译文

1985年5月，经历一场激烈交锋后，苹果董事会最终支持了首席执行官约翰·斯卡利。30岁的史蒂夫·乔布斯，在自己参与创办的公司里被解除管理职务。同年9月，遭到架空和疏远的他辞职了。

把时间倒回三十年前。乔布斯于1955年2月24日生于旧金山，出生不久便被收养。1976年4月1日，他和史蒂夫·沃兹尼亚克创办苹果；首批样机由电子工程师沃兹尼亚克研制。苹果的“车库起源”很大程度上具有象征意义，沃兹尼亚克认为它的重要性被夸大了。苹果于1980年12月12日上市，旗舰产品Macintosh于1984年1月24日首次推出。

离开苹果后的岁月颇有成果。1985年晚些时候，乔布斯创办电脑初创公司NeXT。1986年2月，他收购卢卡斯影业的电脑图形团队，后来发展为皮克斯。皮克斯起初制造专用硬件，主要还不是动画工作室。1995年11月22日上映的《玩具总动员》，成为首部长篇电脑动画电影。

转折发生在1996年12月20日：苹果同意收购NeXT，获得后来Mac OS X所用的核心软件，也让苹果与关系疏远的联合创始人乔布斯重新走到一起。1997年8月，微软向陷入困境的竞争对手苹果投资1.5亿美元；同年9月，乔布斯接掌大权，出任临时负责人。他后来回忆，当时苹果离破产只差几周。此后，iMac、iPod和iPhone相继问世，其中iPhone于2007年1月9日公开亮相。

2003年10月，乔布斯被诊断患有一种罕见的恶性胰腺肿瘤。2011年8月，苹果一度超过埃克森美孚，成为全球市值最高的公司。乔布斯于2011年8月24日卸任，10月5日去世，终年56岁。在那家曾经将他逐出的公司里，他重新掌舵了将近十四年。

eventual Mac OS X指后来出现的系统，不是某个“最终版本”；微软投资的对象是苹果。

核心词汇

先记这22项。连着下方的原文短语一起回想。

confrontation n.
对抗；交锋
a bruising confrontation

board n.
董事会
Apple's board

executive n.
高管；执行官
chief executive John Sculley

be stripped of 动词短语
被剥夺
was stripped of his managerial duties

managerial adj.
管理的
his managerial duties

sideline v.
使失去实权；架空
sidelined and alienated

resign v.
辞职
he resigned

prototype n.
样机
its first prototypes

symbolic adj.
象征性的
largely symbolic

significance n.
重要性；意义
their significance inflated

productive adj.
富有成果的
Exile proved productive

acquire v.
收购
acquired Lucasfilm's

manufacturer n.
制造商
a manufacturer of specialised hardware

reversal n.
局面逆转
The reversal came

eventual adj.
后来出现的；最终的
the eventual Mac OS X

estranged adj.
关系疏远的
its estranged co-founder

distressed adj.
陷入财务困境的
its distressed competitor

competitor n.
竞争对手
its distressed competitor

interim adj.
临时的
as interim chief

diagnosis n.
诊断
received a diagnosis

tenure n.
任期
His tenure ended

at the helm of 介词短语
掌管；领导
at the helm of the company

文中词汇与搭配

补充词汇共42项。保留每个表达在本文中的意思。

bruising adj.
激烈而令人受挫的

ultimately adv.
最终

co-found v.
共同创办

alienate v.
使疏远

rewind v.
倒回；回溯

San Francisco n.
旧金山

adopt v.
收养

newborn n.
新生儿

found v.
创办

electronics n.
电子技术

origin n.
起源

inflate v.
夸大

float v.
上市；公开发行股票

flagship adj.
旗舰的；主打的

debut v.
首次推出

exile n.
被迫离开的时期

start-up n.
初创公司

graphics n.
电脑图形

outfit n.
团队；机构

Pixar n.
皮克斯

specialised adj.
专用的

文中词汇与搭配 续

补充词汇共42项。保留每个表达在本文中的意思。

hardware n.
硬件

animation n.
动画

studio n.
工作室

release v.
上映；发行

feature-length adj.
长篇电影长度的

computer-animated adj.
电脑动画制作的

core adj.
核心的

reunite with 动词短语
与……重聚

invest v.
投资

in prep.
向；对（投资对象）

take the reins 动词短语
接掌大权

ruin n.
破产；毁灭

showcase v.
公开展示

uncommon adj.
罕见的

cancerous adj.
恶性的

pancreatic adj.
胰腺的

tumour n.
肿瘤

briefly adv.
短暂地

overtake v.
超过

valuable adj.
最有价值的；此处指市值最高

oust v.
逐出

回想与回顾

先遮住下方答案，再把四个词放回原文。

01 In May 1985, after a bruising _____, Apple's board ultimately backed chief executive John Sculley.

02 On 1 April 1976 he founded Apple with Steve Wozniak, the electronics engineer behind its first _____.

03 In February 1986 he _____ Lucasfilm's computer-graphics outfit, which became Pixar.

04 In August 1997 Microsoft invested $150 million in its distressed competitor; that September Jobs took the reins as _____ chief.

文章主线

- 创业 1976年，乔布斯与沃兹尼亚克创办苹果，后者研制首批样机；苹果1980年上市，车库起源的意义被夸大。
- 离开 1985年，董事会在冲突中支持首席执行官斯卡利，解除乔布斯管理职务；被架空的乔布斯随后辞职。
- 另起 他创办NeXT，收购皮克斯前身；皮克斯原造专用硬件，1995年推出全球首部长篇电脑动画《玩具总动员》。
- 回归 1996年苹果同意收购NeXT，获得后来Mac OS X的核心软件；次年微软向苹果注资1.5亿美元，乔布斯回归掌舵。
- 重振 iMac、iPod、iPhone相继推出，苹果2011年一度市值全球第一；患胰腺恶性肿瘤的乔布斯同年卸任、去世。

参考答案　1 confrontation 2 prototypes 3 acquired 4 interim